

AGRICULTURE

VARIABLES: Percentage of cropped area under cash crops, gross state domestic product/rural population, electricity consumption for agriculture/rural population, foodgrain yield, loans extended to agriculture/households cultivating land, net irrigated area/net sown area

BIG STATES

RANK 2007		RANK				
		2007	2006	2005	2004	2003
1	PUNJAB	5.62	1	1	1	1
2	TAMIL NADU	3.00	3	3	3	3
3	ANDHRA PRADESH	2.06	5	4	4	4
4	HARYANA	1.94	2	2	2	2
5	GUJARAT	1.90	4	5	5	5
6	KARNATAKA	1.89	6	6	7	6
7	MAHARASHTRA	1.44	10	11	13	9
8	UTTAR PRADESH	1.38	8	7	6	7
9	WEST BENGAL	1.25	7	8	8	8
10	UTTARAKHAND	1.17	12	14	14	NA
11	MADHYA PRADESH	1.11	11	13	9	11
12	RAJASTHAN	1.02	9	9	10	10
13	KERALA	0.91	13	10	12	13
14	BIHAR	0.82	14	12	11	14
15	HIMACHAL PRADESH	0.78	16	16	16	15
16	JAMMU & KASHMIR	0.71	15	15	15	12
17	ORISSA	0.52	17	17	17	16
18	CHHATTISGARH	0.42	18	20	19	NA
19	JHARKHAND	0.24	19	18	20	NA
20	ASSAM	0.21	20	19	18	17

SMALL STATES

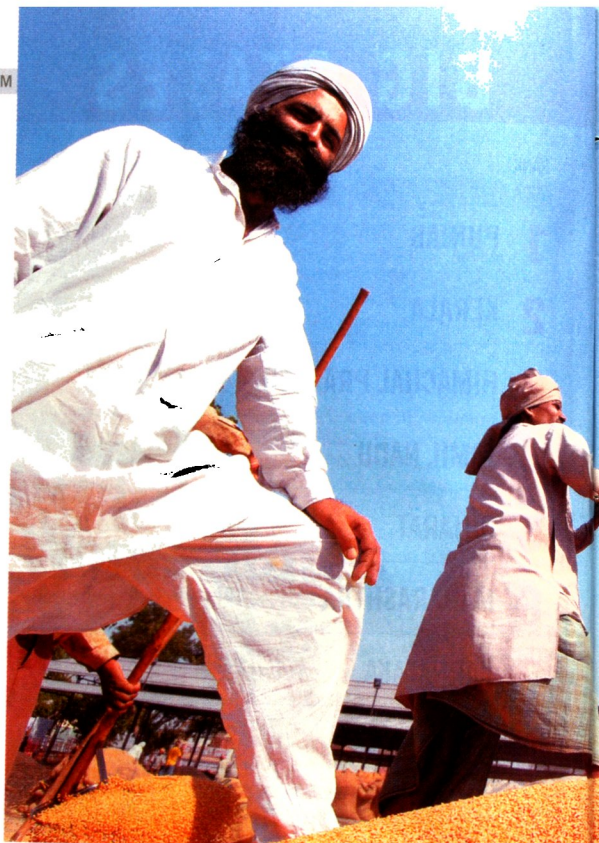
1	PUDUCHERRY	5.46	1	1	1	NA
2	DELHI	1.91	2	2	2	2
3	GOA	1.85	3	3	3	1
4	MEGHALAYA	0.66	5	5	7	NA
5	MANIPUR	0.56	7	6	4	NA
6	ARUNACHAL PRADESH	0.50	8	7	10	NA
7	TRIPURA	0.47	4	4	5	NA
8	MIZORAM	0.46	6	8	6	NA
9	SIKKIM	0.32	10	9	9	NA
10	NAGALAND	0.27	9	10	8	NA

UNION TERRITORIES

1	ANDAMAN & NICOBAR ISLANDS	1.42	1	1	1	NA
2	LAKSHADWEEP	1.10	3	4	4	NA
3	CHANDIGARH	0.93	2	2	2	NA
4	DAMAN & DIU	0.80	5	3	3	NA
5	DADRA & NAGAR HAVELI	0.52	4	5	5	NA

Madhya Pradesh is the FASTEST MOVER

Fastest Mover is the state where the rate of improvement on overall performance between 2003 and 2007 was greater than the rate of improvement between 1991 and 2003



■ By Shankkar Aiyar

History, you could argue, is the best teacher of political economy. The basic lesson political parties and leaders could imbibe from this is that getting it right does not require a post doctorate in rocket science. Development may elude the masses but the definition of economic development is not elusive or mysterious. It is, as the textbook says, about getting the basic foundation right. Very simply, promote agriculture by ensuring credit to farmers and developing irrigation facilities, invest in infrastructure for connectivity between fields and markets, spend on education and health to enable people to benefit from the opportunities and derive revenue from the resultant investments that will boost consumer markets.

Punjab, which has emerged the best overall big state for the fifth year in a row is a textbook case of economic development. Investment in irrigation and infrastructure improved yields and incomes creating a consumer market that delivers revenue. Consider the small state of Puducherry, which has used its strong agrarian economy to invest in health and infrastructure and attract investments. Sure it has the advantage of being bang at the centre of the southern surge, but what is remarkable is that it has ousted states like Goa and Delhi to win the top slot.

Indeed the Fifth India Today Annual State of States report conducted by economists Bibek Debroy and Laveesh Bhandari validates the old dictum of getting the basics right. The study, which provides a window to the performance or the lack of it amongst big and small states, clearly establishes the fact that those who have addressed the social issues—in-